Remote & High-Ticket Selling

What changes when the deal is big and the meeting is a screen, not a room

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PART ONE

A Different Game, Not a Harder One

> *Remote high-ticket selling isn't in-person selling with worse conditions. It runs on different signals entirely, and treating it as a downgraded version of face-to-face selling is the most common reason reps underperform on video.*

In a room, a huge amount of trust gets built without either person saying a word — posture, handshake, shared physical space, the small social choreography of sitting down together. None of that exists on a call. Every signal of competence and trustworthiness has to be carried through voice, framing, and language instead. That's not a disadvantage, but it does mean you have to be deliberate about things that used to happen automatically.

What's actually different at the high-ticket end

Two things compound when the deal size goes up *and* the meeting goes remote:

- **Risk perception is higher.** A buyer committing a large sum, without the reassurance of an in-person relationship, is taking on more perceived risk than either factor alone would create. Your job shifts further toward reducing that risk and further away from generic persuasion.
- **Committees, not individuals, often decide.** Larger deals increasingly involve multiple stakeholders weighing in asynchronously — which means the conversation you have on the call is often not the only conversation that decides the deal. What you leave behind (a one-pager, a clear summary, specific language your contact can repeat to others) matters as much as what you say live.

A MENTAL MODEL WORTH KEEPING

Most objections in large remote deals today don't form during your call — they form before it, while the buyer is researching alone, and they form afterward, in conversations you're not in the room for. Your call is one input among several. Plan for what happens after you hang up, not just for what happens while you're talking.

PART TWO

Camera, Presence, and Frame Control

Camera on, every time

This is the single most consistent, most measurable lever in remote selling. Across large datasets of recorded sales calls, closed deals use video meaningfully more often than lost deals, and win rates are substantially higher when the rep keeps their camera on throughout the call — not just at the start. Two mechanisms explain why:

- You can read engagement signals — posture, attention, hesitation — that audio alone hides completely.
- When you turn your camera on, the buyer is more likely to turn theirs on too, and that mutual visibility builds trust faster than voice alone ever does.

The practical rule: camera on before you say hello, and stay on it for the whole call, including the parts that feel administrative. Reps often turn the camera off during screen-shares or demos — that's exactly when buyer engagement starts to drift, and it's the easiest moment to lose someone without noticing.

Frame control: whoever sets the agenda guides the conversation

On a call, without the natural structure of an in-person meeting, conversations drift more easily — toward small talk, toward the buyer's tangents, toward losing the thread entirely. Frame control means you open by stating what the call will cover and roughly how long it'll take, and you gently bring the conversation back to that structure when it wanders.

> **EXAMPLE — SETTING THE FRAME**
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> `"In the next twenty minutes I'd like to understand what's driving this project for you, walk through how we'd approach it, and figure out together whether it's a fit. Does that work, or is there something specific you want to make sure we cover?"`

Note the last sentence — frame control isn't about steamrolling the conversation, it's about proposing a structure and inviting the buyer into it. That small act of asking already builds collaborative trust.

PART THREE

Opening a Remote Call: The First 30 Seconds

> *On a cold call or first remote meeting, you have a very short window before the other person decides, half-consciously, whether this is worth their attention. The opening line matters more on a call than in person, because there's no body language to soften a weak one.*

What kills an opening

Generic, low-confidence openers ("Hi, just checking if you have a minute...") signal low status and invite an easy brush-off. The brain processes that kind of opener as background noise within the first few words.

What works instead

A strong opening states who you are, respects their time explicitly, and gives a specific, relevant reason for the call — ideally something that shows you've done a little homework, not a generic pitch.

WEAK OPENING

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"Hi, is now a good time? I wanted to tell you about our product..."
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STRONGER STRUCTURE

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"Hi [name], it's [your name]. I'll keep this brief. I noticed [specific,
relevant observation about their situation]. Can I ask you one quick
question about that?"
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The structure does three things in a few seconds: states who's talking, respects their time up front (which paradoxically buys you more attention, not less), and earns the right to ask a question by showing you've thought about their specific situation rather than running a script at them.

Tone over volume

On the phone or over video, tone carries more of the meaning than it does in person, simply because there's less else to read. Certainty and calm in your voice land disproportionately well; hesitation is amplified, not minimized, by the medium. This is one reason rehearsing openings out loud — not just reading them — matters more for remote selling than for in-person.

PART FOUR

De-Risking the Buyer Instead of Discounting

> *At the high-ticket end, the instinct to lower the price when a buyer hesitates is almost always the wrong move. The hesitation is rarely about the number — it's about risk.*

Why discounting backfires

Dropping the price in response to hesitation does two things, both bad: it suggests the original number wasn't solid, which damages trust in your pricing generally, and it trains the buyer that pushback gets rewarded, which invites more of it later in the deal — on terms, on scope, on everything.

What to do instead: lower the perceived risk, not the price

Buyers hesitating on a large purchase are usually running an internal calculation: *value minus risk* needs to clear a bar before they'll commit. You can move that calculation in your favor by addressing the risk side directly, several ways:

- **Specific proof, not generic testimonials.** A case study from a buyer in a similar situation, with a real, specific outcome, does more to lower perceived risk than any amount of persuasive language.
- **Guarantees or a smaller first commitment.** A money-back guarantee or a scoped-down pilot lets the buyer test the relationship without betting everything on day one.
- **Transparency about limitations.** Paradoxically, openly naming what your offer doesn't do builds more trust than a flawless pitch — it signals you're not overselling, which makes everything else you say more credible.
- **Helping the buyer build internal consensus.** In committee-based deals, give your main contact something concrete — a one-page brief tailored to a specific stakeholder's likely concern (finance, technical, operational) — so they can sell internally on your behalf when you're not in the room.

REFRAMING THE PRICE ITSELF

Language shapes how a number feels even before any risk-reduction tactic kicks in. Calling it an "investment" rather than a "cost" shifts the frame toward long-term return rather than immediate expense. This isn't about euphemism — it only works if the underlying ROI case is genuinely there to back it up.

PART FIVE

Drills

✎ Drill 1 — Camera audit

Review your last three remote calls (or recall them in detail). Was your camera on the entire time, including screen-shares? If not, identify exactly which moments you went off-camera, and rebuild those segments with the camera on.

✎ Drill 2 — Rebuild your opening line

Write three versions of your cold-call or first-meeting opener using the "who I am, respect for time, specific observation, one question" structure. Say each out loud and time it — it should land in under fifteen seconds.

✎ Drill 3 — Risk, not price

Think of the last deal where a buyer hesitated on price. Write down what you actually said in response. Then rewrite your response using a risk-reduction lever (proof, guarantee, pilot, or transparency) instead of touching the number.

✎ Drill 4 — Frame-setting practice

Write a 2-sentence frame-setting opener for your most common type of call (discovery, demo, or closing call) that states the structure and invites the buyer to adjust it.

MODULE SUMMARY

Remote and high-ticket selling run on different signals than in-person, low-stakes selling. Keep the camera on for the entire call. Control the frame by proposing structure, not by dominating the conversation. Win the first thirty seconds with a specific, respectful opener. And when a high-ticket buyer hesitates, address the risk behind the hesitation — not the price.